COMPANY DEEP-DIVE

Former Executive Vice President of Operations at RYZE Claim Solutions Believes AI Automation Enhances Claims Processing Efficiency Despite Initial ROI Challenges

DATE PUBLISHED	INTERVIEW DATE	EXPERT PERSPECTIVE	ANALYST PERSPECTIVE	PRIMARY COMPANY
06 Aug 2026	08 May 2026	Customer	Investor-Led (Buy-Side)	PACE (WITHPACE)

SMART SUMMARY

Summary

The conversation covered the expert's experience implementing AI-driven workflow automation solutions for insurance claims operations, focusing on use cases, efficiency gains, pricing models, integration, and industry challenges related to automation.

EXPERT BACKGROUND

- Former executive with over 17 years of experience in the insurance industry, primarily in claims, claims leadership, operations, sourcing, procurement, and vendor management, with significant involvement in implementing technology solutions to drive operational efficiencies.

EXPERT SENTIMENT

- The expert views automation solutions as offering significant long-term value, particularly in scalability and efficiency during high-volume claim events, though initial ROI may not be immediately realized.
- The expert believes that while automation can drive efficiency and quality, there are important considerations around client-specific requirements and future legal or contractual implications of using third-party platforms.

TAKEAWAYS

- The expert worked closely with an AI workflow automation vendor on two projects: automating QA review of claim files and automating manual claim entry from various submission formats.
- **Automation provided efficiency gains**, particularly in the ability to scale claim processing rapidly during surge events, though the full ROI was not realized before the expert's departure.
- **The main industry challenge** is adapting automation to diverse client requirements and submission formats, which the expert sees as a key differentiator for vendors.
- Pricing models typically involve an implementation fee and a usage-based or volume-based cost structure, with spend increasing as scope and usage grow.
- Implementation was described as straightforward, with the vendor being communicative and responsive, and integration with existing systems requiring minimal development effort.

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Expert Bio

Former Executive Vice President Of Operations at RYZE Claim Solutions, leaving in Q1 2026, a customer of Pace. The expert is an operations executive with 8+ years of experience leading enterprise-scale claims and insurance adjacent service platforms in highly regulated environments. The expert has a proven track record of operational transformation across vendor networks, claims workflows, billing, and compliance, delivering cost reduction, improved service performance, and scalable execution. The expert has also overseen M&A integrations for operational readiness.

Interview Transcript

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Client 00:00:00

Thank you for taking the time. I'm researching AI insurtech, so looking at companies like Pace AI, FurtherAI, Outmarket, Fulcrum, all these new agentic workflow platforms for insurers. I'm trying to understand where everyone's playing, what are they fixing for, what's working, what's not. I saw your profile was interesting because you're currently a customer at Pace, so I just wanted to validate first that.

Expert 00:00:28

I am no longer in that role with RYZE, but I did work very closely with Pace on two different projects when I was there.

Client 00:00:36

Awesome. If you could give me a little bit of your background, and then I'll go into the Pace questions.

Expert 00:00:42

Sure. I've been in the industry for over 17 years, primarily on the carrier side, working in claims and then moving into claims leadership, operational roles, sourcing and procurement, vendor management. Eight years ago is when I started working heavily in operations leadership. When I joined RYZE in 2022 in shared services and operations, that's when we started looking at implementing technology to drive efficiencies, eliminate manual workflows. I separated from RYZE in January of this year. That's a little bit about my background. Hopefully, that's helpful.

Client 00:01:19

Thank you. In your time at RYZE, when you were evaluating these solutions like Pace, did **you see any other similar competitors** as well?

Expert 00:01:29

For the projects that I was a part of, no. We had one other project that we used Riveron for because we had engaged them in the past, prior to my arrival at RYZE, for some work with integrating our financial system with our claim system. We did work with them on an invoice automation project. Otherwise, Pace was a referral made to us by our private equity partner.

Client 00:01:51

Got it. Once you engaged with them, was it directly with the founder? Was he doing the sales, or was it more of a salesperson, go-to-market person?

Expert 00:02:03

We initially worked with Jamie for a QA project. That was the first interaction we had with Pace. I believe **they were growing fairly** quickly as that was launching. We then started to work with some of the integration teams for the latter project. We were automating claims setup, so we took the manual process of entering claims and were working with them to automate that.

Client 00:02:26

Got it. Could you walk me a little bit more in-depth in both use cases? The first one about QA, specifically, in what workflow were you conducting this QA?

Expert 00:02:38

In the IA space, the field adjuster conducts the investigation and returns an estimate report and photos that is then QA reviewed internally before it's sent to the client. What we were encountering was a bottleneck in that workflow. You've got a human being who's got to open all of those documents and review them against a carrier or client's specific guidelines related to their claim handling. What we worked with Pace on was creating an agent that would go in, follow a set of specific rules. Those rules would trigger, and it would either pass or fail based on the rules specific to that client. **We were able to get quite an efficiency gain with that process implementation**.

Client 00:03:19

That, you said, is for the submission aspect?

Expert 00:03:22

It's checking the file for guideline adherence prior to sending the file back to the client.

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Client 00:03:28
Got it. That was the QA part. The second use case is more related to the claim management itself?

Expert 00:03:36
This is pretty standard across the industry. Clients submit claims in several different formats and workflows. Sometimes, there's an integration between the estimating platform and our claim system. Sometimes, we receive emails. Sometimes, they're called in. We were finding that there were a lot of claims being set up manually, which required human beings to open the file, extract information, go into the claim system, enter the required fields to create that new claim in our system.

Because we had already worked with Pace and liked the relationship and the product they were providing, we worked with them through automating the process for manual claim creation. It's almost like an email parsing tool on steroids. It would go in, extract the data required from the email or attached documents to be able to create the claim in our claim system. Eliminated a lot of the manual piece of that.

Client 00:04:34
Got it. You're working with Pace, they're doing great. "Okay, let's see if they can handle these other use cases." Was that more of an ask from you, "We have proved them, and now we can see if they can manage a little bit more," or was it their own team, they saw you have opportunity to automate this as well, and they proposed that proactively?

Expert 00:04:58
I'd say a mix of both. I believe they were already working on automating similar workflows for other clients, but hadn't really focused on it as largely as we needed to. We were thinking about ways. We were going to explore email parsing tools. It came up in a conversation, a weekly update with the QA team that was still refining some of the process for the QA piece. The question came up, "Can you assist us with automating the manual claim entry?" I think it was still a little exploratory on their side.

Client 00:05:31
Thank you. That's clear. In terms of the ROI that they're delivering, are you comparing them with, I don't know if you were using BPOs to do this before, so in that case, you would compare it to the BPO spend, or were you comparing them to maybe internal spend, or maybe the ROI is related to speed and quality and that's just not the way to look at it?

Expert 00:05:52
I think ideally, you are comparing the ROI to what you're spending for BPO. I think a lot of clients in the industry, from my experience, are outsourcing this piece of the workflow. We had an internal team of two to three people, and when I left RYZE, the project was still in process, so I don't have a full accurate ROI. I will tell you that we were focusing on speed and quality. The bonus with this process with Pace is that the time to enter a claim manually versus the agent doing the work, there was not that significant of a time savings because we were still refining that tool as we were working.

Where the big savings are is the ability to use this when we need to scale very quickly because the agent is able to create several claims at the same time, whereas a human doing it can only do one at a time. We weren't able to actualize the ROI in that space, we couldn't test that yet. Does that make sense?

Client 00:06:49
There's no bottleneck. Therefore, if there's a surge, le**'s say there's a wildfire** and everyone's filing claims, then it doesn't matter because you have agents, you don't have people, so you don't need to prioritize claims or only work on batches. Is that what you meant?

Expert 00:07:07
Right. We can give 100 emails to the agent versus one person doing one email at one time.

Client 00:07:15
Got it. In terms of accuracy, did you notice any improvements?

Expert 00:07:22
We did. Anything like this is going to have issues. **I think the biggest problem in our industry**, especially in the IA space, is that our clients are all different. They all have different requirements and guidelines, and they all submit claims in different forms and fashions. The

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ability to adapt or conform to their requirements is, I think, the biggest game changer in this space. **That's the biggest issue in the industry for claims vendors**.

Client 00:07:51
The complexity.

Expert 00:07:52
Yes.

Client 00:07:53
Got it. I'm just trying to understand how they compare to a BPO in terms of speed, quality, and cost. I don't expect specific numbers in terms of how much you're paying them, but in the ranges. In your case, it's different because you had internal people working on it. If you can give me your experience on how do they compare versus a BPO in terms of speed, quality, and spend?

Expert 00:08:18
In my opinion, I think you're not going to see the ROI initially with the automation, but long term, the cost benefit is there because you are outsourcing, unless there is some sort of AI they're using. I'm not certain on that. It's the model that we were using. It's one person entering one claim at a time. In my experience in other processes that have been outsourced in my background, you're not getting the same quality as you are if you have someone who is onshore in your office, understands the industry, understands the client's guidelines and variations.

I'm not sure on the cost perspective, just because we didn't do a lot of research on outsourcing this process. We really wanted to focus on getting this automated because of the ability to scale if a large volume of claims comes in. I know that's a long-winded way of saying. I'm not sure if that answers your question. We don't have a really great comparison.

Client 00:09:14
No, that's fair. I'd like to understand how they price. Again, I don't need specific. I'm just trying to understand, is it a per-seat or platform fee or per document volume, usage-based? What type of pricing model were they using?

Expert 00:09:32
I can say in a general sense, I think you're going to find that a lot of vendors in this space are going to start with an implementation fee. I believe there's typically an upfront cost. I think there are some unique instances. The relationship with Pace was a little unique because we already had a contract in place for the QA development, and so we were able to agree on continuation and expansion of that, so that the work for the claim creation automation fed out of that contract. Does that make sense?

Client 00:10:02
It's not like they added another setup fee. It was because you were doing more usage, volume of work increased, so therefore, **spend increased.** It's not like you added a full other module.

Expert 00:10:14
I think you'll find that **they will charge an implementation fee, and then there will be a volume cost** associated with work that's done or claims that flow through the platform. That's what I would say. I think that's what you'd find.

Client 00:10:29
Okay. Just to be clear, when **you expanded their scope, spend grows because usage grows because of higher scope of work**?

Expert 00:10:37
Yes. I feel like it's fair to say that our situation was very unique because of the relationship that we already had. The second project that we pitched and agreed on wasn't something that they had really fully developed out yet.

Client 00:10:51
It was more like a design partner type of relationship.

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Expert 00:10:56
Correct. That's why I say I think you'll find that in the industry, the standard or typical pricing structure might be an implementation or platform fee and then a per claim or volume cost associated with usage.

Client 00:11:08
Got it. In terms of the initial setup, how painful or easy out of the box versus customized was it, and how long did it take?

Expert 00:11:19
I wasn't initially involved with the QA project implementation team on our side. I know that Pace was very communicative and very easy to work with. We were initially meeting two to three times per week. I had one internal operations manager who was creating the repository of information and data fields and was the liaison between our IT and their implementation team. I'd say maybe hours per week. Is that what you're looking for?

Client 00:11:46
No. When you decided to go with the project, how long did it take until fully running?

Expert 00:11:53
That's a good question. I want to say it was in use within 30 days. Let's say 30-60 days, just to be fair.

Client 00:12:02
Okay. In terms of integrating with your existing tech and existing processes, did that require a lot of tech involvement, or was it pretty seamless?

Expert 00:12:12
I believe it was fairly simple development work by one of our in-house developers because she actually helped build the claim system. We had a homegrown claims platform. The only reason it was more labor-intensive is because she was stretched very thin working on multiple projects.

Client 00:12:29
Okay. They will adapt to whatever existing tech you have?

Expert 00:12:35
I'm not the most tech-savvy when it comes to development and code and things like that, but it seemed in the meetings that we were having that these were not extensive or exhaustive development efforts. They were pretty straightforward and fairly surface-level.

Client 00:12:50
Okay. Was the customer satisfaction, and I'm talking end customer here, ever a consideration in terms of key purchasing criteria or going with Pace, trying to improve the end customer experience?

Expert 00:13:03
The end customer being the IA firm or the end customer being the carrier that is our client?

Client 00:13:08
The carrier that is your client.

Expert 00:13:11
I don't believe there were initial conversations with the clients about using any automation tools. Moving forward, that conversation does need to happen because of potential legal exposure.

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Client 00:13:22

Going into that, the AI basically parses documents, sorts information, and structures it in a way that's easier to digest and to manage and to use the data. Does it conduct the actual claim adjustment or settling, or is it more of a document management tool?

Expert 00:13:39

It doesn't adjudicate claims, but the data is still flowing through a third party. There are sometimes requirements that the clients have in the contracts that we sign that require permissive use of third-party platforms.

Client 00:13:51

Was that part of the conversation when you started working with them? How did they clear that concern?

Expert 00:13:58

We didn't have those conversations.

Client 00:14:01

Do you think that, eventually, is something that they'll have to sort out? Especially for third party, whenever they're not directly embedded into the carrier who already owns the relationship and owns the data. Whenever they're working with the third parties, do you see that as something that they're going to have to clear out eventually?

Expert 00:14:19

I truly feel it's something that just based on the respect of the relationship and contractual obligations, it's a conversation that should be had. I don't know that it's going to, because everything that you're seeing now and the direction that everybody is moving is, "Let's automate every single portion of the process that we can to drive efficiency." **I don't know that there have been any negative repercussions from tech use at this point** when it comes to case law or claim outcomes, but I do think it's something that future state will probably have more optics and should have more optics.

Client 00:14:52

How sticky do you think they are as a solution? If tomorrow someone goes to RYZE and they say, "Oh, **Pace is bankrupt**, we got to get rid of them," how painful would it be?

Expert 00:15:04

That's a great question. I think **they're building a pretty solid reliance**. I think where the greatest value is will be if there's a hurricane or a large weather event, and they get 10,000 claims at once. Maybe it's not as sticky right now. Especially with the development work they put into it. I think because of their ability to run multiple claims at one time versus one claim at one time, that's where the reliance will become very, very heavy.

Client 00:15:31

Awesome. My last question is, if you could give me an example of something that they've done well, a specific thing that, "Oh, they did this very well, and I remember this." Do you have any examples?

Expert 00:15:47

I think, just generally speaking, **their relationship management was really good**. I think their availability to answer questions, to solution problems as they arose, there's large value in that to the client.

Client 00:16:00

These were all the questions I had for today, so thank you so much for your time.

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